

Why Is Zomato Losing My Trust After the Order Arrives?

A self-directed product teardown by Sudesh

WHY I DID THIS

I use food delivery apps almost every week, and I keep noticing the same complaints from other users online — not about the food discovery experience, but about what happens when something goes wrong after the order arrives. I wanted to practice thinking like a PM: find real problems, decide which one actually deserves to be fixed first, and write it up the way a product team would.

WHAT I FOUND

I read through app-store reviews, complaint forums, and public consumer-affairs data on Zomato, and kept a running list of what people were actually frustrated about. Five problems came up again and again: missing items in the order, late or missing refunds, bad food quality, an unresponsive support team, and wrong deliveries or cancellations. Interestingly, three of these — missing items, refunds, and support — all trace back to the same broken moment: what happens after a customer says “something's wrong with my order.”

SCORING THE PROBLEMS (RICE)

I couldn't fix all five at once, so I scored each one on Reach, Impact, Confidence, and Effort — a framework called RICE that most product teams use to decide what to build first. A higher score means higher priority.

	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	Score
Missing items in order	6	3	74%	5	2.66
Late / no refund issued	7	3	85%	7	2.55
Bad quality food	6	3	63%	7	1.62
Support team not responding	5	2	79%	6	1.32
Wrong delivery / order cancelled	5	2	69%	6	1.15

My pick: Missing items scored highest, so that's what I built a fix for — though honestly, fixing the whole resolution process behind it would help all three related problems at once.

MY PROPOSED FIX

As a customer who has experienced missing items in food deliveries, I want a one-tap reporting system that provides swift resolution, not prolonged back-and-forth negotiations with support about compensation I'm entitled to. Immediately following delivery, the app prompts users with "Did you get everything?" and provides a simple one-tap checklist of all ordered items. If something's missing, the claim is auto-checked against the restaurant's packing record or the delivery photo — clear cases get an instant refund or reorder, no waiting. Unclear cases go to a real person with a visible promise, like “resolved within 2 hours,” instead of a vague “under review.” How I'd know it's working:

More claims resolved automatically within minutes, not days.

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY NEXT TIME

The RICE scoring taught me something I wouldn't have seen just from reading complaints — three separate-looking problems were really one process failing in different ways. If I took this further, I'd want to actually interview 5-10 users instead of relying only on public reviews, and test whether fixing the shared resolution process beats fixing each symptom on its own.